dependency ratio will result in improving India's competitiveness in the global economy. The Government of India seems fully aware of this advantage and that is why the Eleventh Plan (2007–12) is implementing a ***three-pronged strategy*** to tap demographic dividend:

(i) Ensuring proper healthcare to all,

(ii) Emphasis on skill development (knowledge industry), and

(iii) Encouragement of labour intensive industries.

The Eleventh Plan document also suggests a word of caution—'if we get our skill development act right, we will be harnessing a demographic dividend, however, if we fail to create skills, we could be facing a demographic nightmare.'

Q. 25 Write a short note on the recently launched National Food Security Mission.

Ans. India's food secruity scenario has been a matter of concern for the important national and international agencies in the recent times—so has it been for the Government of India. The issue was discussed in a constructive way at the 53rd meeting of the National Development Council (NDC) early 2007. In pursuance of the resolution of the NDC, the Department of Agriculture & Cooperation, Ministry of Agriculture launched a Centrally - sponsored scheme on National Food Security Mission (NFSM) starting with the Eleventh Plan. The ***objective*** of the Mission is to increase the production of rice, wheat and pulses by 10, 8 and 2 million tonnes, respectively, over the benchmark levels of production, by the end of the Eleventh Plan. The Mission *aims* to do the same through the following ***measures:***

(i) Area expansion and productivity enhancement;

(ii) Restoring soil fertility and productivity;

(iii) Creating employment opportunities, and

(iv) Enhancing farm level economy to restore confidence of farmers of targeted districts.

The implementation of the NFSM relates to *various activities* pointed by the Government as given below:

(i) Demonstration of improved production technology;